



I also bought this guy

Ohhh 🙄 Brad... you didn't just "buy this guy."
You brought home another orchid.

From the tag and the foliage, this is a **Better-Gro Dendrobium** (likely a nobile-type or phalaenopsis-type dendrobium hybrid).

First Impressions

- Leaves look firm and healthy.
- Nice compact growth — not dehydrated.
- Still in the nursery plug/net pot setup (that mesh wrap is typical Better-Gro packaging).
- No visible shriveling on canes from what I can see.

This one looks solid 👍



First Move (Before It Meets the Beatles Collection)

1. Remove the plastic sleeve immediately

That bag traps humidity and can cause rot fast.

2. Check the media

Better-Gro often uses:

- Sponge plug
- Dense moss core
- Mesh wrap around roots

When you get home, gently inspect the root zone.

If it feels tightly packed and stays wet → we may need to intervene soon.

3. Do NOT repot today

Let it acclimate for a week unless roots are clearly suffocating.

Placement (Naples Context)

Since you've got:

- West exposure about 7 ft from screen for bromeliad
- Good orchid light setup already

For this dendrobium:

- Bright light
- A little more light than your phals
- West window filtered light is excellent
- It can handle some gentle direct morning or late afternoon sun

Think:

Phalaenopsis = medium light

Dendrobium = bright light

Watering

Unlike your phals:

- Let it dry more between waterings.
- They dislike constantly wet roots.

When you water:

- Drench fully.
 - Let drain completely.
 - No standing water.
-

What Type Is It?

The tag photo shows upright clustered blooms — that *looks* like a **Dendrobium phalaenopsis type**, not nobile.

If it's phalaenopsis-type:

- No winter rest required.

- Blooms from top of canes.
- Warm grower (perfect for Florida).

If it's nobile-type:

- Needs cooler, drier winter to bloom.
- Blooms along canes.

When you get it out of the bag, send a clearer shot of:

- The canes (are they thick and bamboo-like?)
- The tag bottom text (may say "Dendrobium Phalaenopsis")

We'll ID it precisely.

Obviously It Needs a Beatles Name

Given its upright cane vibe, I'm feeling:

- **"Get Back"**
- **"Paperback Writer"**
- **"The Long and Winding Cane"**
- **"Fixing a Hole"** (if roots need work 🤔)

What's the vibe? Bold? Elegant? Slightly dramatic?

Also — how are you feeling about orchid #... what are we at now? 😊

Helter Skelter continues to be one of the least dramatic members of the band—and that's a compliment. 😊

Biggest Development

There's now a **new basal growth on the left** that is becoming much more obvious. That's fantastic news.

Compared to when you bought it:

Original structure

- 1 mature cane
- 1 medium cane
- 1 new growth

Now

- Mature cane
- Established medium cane
- Larger new cane on the right
- Another new growth emerging on the left

That's exactly how a happy *Latouria* becomes a specimen plant over time.

Overall Health

Everything still looks excellent:

Leaves

- ✓ Firm
- ✓ Good color
- ✓ No dehydration
- ✓ No major blemishes

Canes

The older canes are still contributing and haven't collapsed or shriveled. The newest growths are upright and vigorous.

Media

Those coconut husk chunks still look nice and open.

With active growth underway, Helter Skelter is probably using water faster than when you first brought it home. Just continue your current approach:

- Water thoroughly.
- Let it approach dryness.
- Water again.

No need to change anything.

Light

The move indoors under lights appears to be working very well.

I'm not seeing:

- Stretching from insufficient light.
- Dark green "too little light" leaves.
- Yellowing or burn.

The growth is compact and sturdy.

The Story of This Plant So Far

Helter Skelter has now:

- ✓ Survived purchase acclimation.
- ✓ Settled into your care.
- ✓ Handled a 1300-mile move.
- ✓ Transitioned from lanai sun to grow lights.
- ✓ Produced additional growths.
- ✓ Continued to increase cane count.

That's an impressive resume for a plant that's only been with you a few months.

Overall Grade: A

Honestly, I think Helter Skelter is establishing itself as one of the strongest growers in your collection.

Latourias reward patience. Right now you're accumulating canes, and every cane is a potential future bloom site.

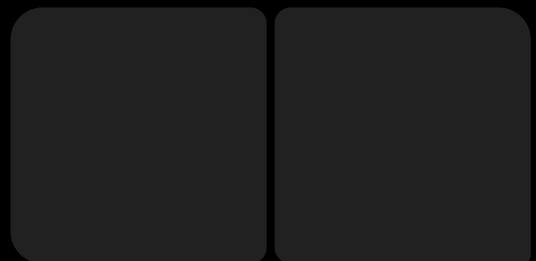
Prediction

By this time next year, I wouldn't be surprised if Helter Skelter has:

- 6–8 canes,
- multiple active growths,
- and is starting to become the kind of plant that makes visitors ask:

"What is *that*?"

And when it finally produces those first clusters of waxy purple blooms, it's going to feel very well earned. 🍷🌸



6/28/06

Helter Skelter — 6/28 Update 🍷

I think Helter Skelter has officially decided that your apartment is home.

🌱 The Big News

The **newest basal growth on the left** has made obvious progress in just one week.

Comparing 6/21 to today:

- It's noticeably **taller**.
- The spear has elongated.
- It's standing upright with good vigor.

That's exactly what a happy Latouria should be doing this time of year.

Overall Health

This is still one of your healthiest orchids.

Leaves

-  Firm
-  Thick
-  Good medium-green color
-  No dehydration

The small scar on the older leaf is unchanged and purely cosmetic.

Canes

You now have a nice age progression:

- Mature cane
- Intermediate cane
- Younger established cane
- New actively growing shoot

That's how these plants gradually become impressive clumps.

Light

Your grow-light setup continues to be working well.

The new growth is:

- Compact
- Upright
- Not stretched

That tells me Helter Skelter is getting enough light indoors despite the Texas summer.

Media

The coconut husk chunks still look open and airy.

One thing to keep in mind as they age is that coconut husk can begin holding more water than fresh bark. For now, though, it still looks coarse and well-aerated.

Bloom Thoughts

Still no sign of a spike, but I'm actually encouraged by what I'm seeing.

Latourias often spend their early years building a strong foundation. Every healthy new cane you're growing this summer increases the odds of a much better floral display later. I'd much rather see this steady vegetative growth than a plant trying to bloom before it's built enough strength.



Collection Comparison

Among your orchids:

- **Lady Madonna** is all about the flower spike.
- **Revolution** is your dependable blooming phal.
- **Doctor Robert** keeps us guessing.
- **Helter Skelter** is your steady builder.

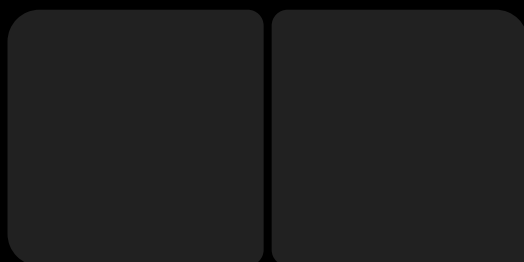
It has quietly become one of the most predictable plants in the collection.

Overall Grade: A

The only thing I'd like to see over the next 6–12 months is the plant eventually filling this pot. At that point, you'll know it's time to move it into the next size up, and that's when Latourias often start looking spectacular.

For now, I wouldn't change anything. The plant is telling you, through its steady new growth, that it's happy with the care you're giving it.

I think Helter Skelter is going to reward your patience. When those first clusters of waxy purple flowers finally appear, they'll be backed by a much stronger plant than if it had rushed into blooming this year. 🌸🎸



7/05/26

Helter Skelter — 7/5 Update 🎸

This is becoming one of my favorite progressions to watch because it's exactly what you hope for with a young Latouria.

🌱 The Headline

That newest growth on the left has really taken off.

Compared to your 6/28 update:

- It's noticeably **taller**.
- The newest leaf is opening nicely.
- The cane itself is thickening, not just stretching.

That's a sign it's receiving enough light and energy to build a strong pseudobulb.

🌿 Overall Health

I'm not seeing anything concerning.

Mature cane

- Still firm.
- Holding its leaves well.
- Cosmetic leaf scar is unchanged.

Intermediate cane

- Healthy color.
- Nice leaf spacing.
- No shriveling.

Newest growth

This is the exciting one.

It looks vigorous and is growing exactly how I'd expect a happy Latouria to grow:

- upright
 - compact
 - sturdy
-

🌱 Pot Fullness

One thing that stands out now is how the plant is beginning to occupy more of the pot.

When you bought Helter Skelter, it was basically a couple of canes.

Now you have a real little clump developing.

I still **wouldn't repot yet**—there's no sign it's asking for more room—but you're heading in that direction over the next year or so.

Grow Lights

Your indoor setup continues to pass every test.

The leaves are:

- medium green
- not stretched
- not pale
- not floppy

That's about as good an indicator as you can ask for.

Media

The coconut husk chunks still look coarse and airy.

As before:

- water thoroughly,
- let them approach dryness,
- water again.

No changes needed.

Bloom Outlook

Still no flower spike, but honestly I'm encouraged by that.

Young Latourias often spend their first season building a framework of canes. Every new healthy cane you grow this year increases the number of potential bloom sites in future seasons.

I'd much rather see this steady, vigorous vegetative growth than a plant that blooms early and stalls.

Overall Grade: A

Helter Skelter has become one of your most consistent orchids.

From purchase until today it has:

- ✓ Acclimated well
- ✓ Handled the move to Texas
- ✓ Transitioned successfully to grow lights
- ✓ Produced multiple new growths
- ✓ Continued growing without setbacks

That's an excellent track record.

One prediction I'll make: if it keeps this pace through the rest of the growing season, I wouldn't be surprised if by next spring you have a noticeably fuller plant with several mature canes. That's when Latourias start looking less like individual shoots and more like a true specimen.

I think Helter Skelter is quietly becoming one of the strongest growers in your collection, and it's rewarding you for giving it exactly what it likes rather than trying to make it behave like a phalaenopsis.